

English in my home – Someone on the phone

Unit 2



Contents

- Unit 2a**
- A cold call – teacher's notes**
 - A cold call – learner resources**
 - A cold call – video transcript**
 - A cold call – additional resources for teachers**
 - A cold call – answers**
- Unit 2b**
- Wrong number – teacher's notes**
 - Wrong number – learner resources**
 - Wrong number – answers**
 - Wrong number – full video transcript**
- Unit 2c**
- An emergency – teacher's notes**
 - An emergency – learner resources (including transcript)**
 - An emergency – answers**
- Unit 2d**
- Getting a plumber – teacher's notes**
 - Getting a plumber – learner resources**
 - Getting a plumber – answers**

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

Introduction

This resource has been produced in two different formats:

- a self-access resource for learners with online activities
- this teacher's pack, including teacher's notes and learner resources to download

Overview

This resource, **Someone on the phone** is Unit 2 of *English in my home*, which aims to give ESOL learners the confidence and the language to deal with situations they may encounter in their homes.

The three units of *English in my home* are:

Unit 1 Someone at the door aims to give learners confidence and equip them with the language necessary to deal with situations where unexpected callers (e.g. an electricity meter reader) arrive at the door.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone shows how to deal with incoming phone calls from a range of people. This includes unwanted calls (e.g. marketing cold calls).

Unit 3 Something in the post features some common types of mail that people receive (e.g. a utility bill), and enables learners to understand what the text means, and to know what to do in response.

Level: Entry 2 / Access 3 in Scotland / CEF A2. The materials are designed to be flexible in terms of differentiation, and are accessible to established E2 learners and at the same time relevant to E1, as well as E3 and L1.

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

Structure, learning hours and delivery context

English in my home provides a minimum of 11 hours of learning in a classroom or self-access context through a series of three linked units. Each unit can be taught as a standalone. Here is an overview of the content of each unit. Each unit has four topics:

Unit 1: Someone at the door (includes films)

- Topic a: Electricity meter reading
- Topic b: Charity collection
- Topic c: Parcel delivery
- Topic d: The neighbour

Unit 2: Someone on the phone (includes films)

- Topic a: A cold call
- Topic b: Wrong number
- Topic c: An emergency
- Topic d: Getting a plumber

Unit 3: Something in the post

- Topic a: Bank statement
- Topic b: Phone bill
- Topic c: Attempted delivery note
- Topic d: Note from a neighbour

Each of the four topics in *Someone at the door* and *Someone on the phone* features a short film. These films have been scripted specifically for the project, and involve actors. The two central characters are a married Indian couple, who have recently moved to the UK, and who are getting used to life here. Each film focuses on them in a specific scenario, such as dealing with a meter reader who arrives at their flat, or dealing with unwanted cold calls on the telephone. ESOL learners should be able to relate to the experiences of the couple.

The learner materials and teacher notes contain activities for use before, during and after watching the films. They enable the learners to notice, learn and use some of the functional language featured in the films.

Something in the post, uses semi-authentic material of the kinds that learners may receive in their home, and helps them to understand these and know what action is needed.

Most topics provide approximately 60 minutes of classroom time.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone: overview

This unit provides up to 4 hours of classroom time, and covers 4 topics. Each topic features a short film, commissioned by the British Council for the ESOL Nexus project, and filmed with professional actors. The films aim to show situations in which ESOL learners may find themselves, and the accompanying classroom and self-study materials aim to give learners the language they need to deal with a range of household situations.

The topics of *Someone on the phone* are called *A cold call*, *Wrong number*, *An emergency*, and *Getting a plumber*. The first two topics can be used in any order but ideally *An emergency* should be taught before *Getting a plumber*.

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

English in my home – Someone on the phone

Unit 2a – Cold call



Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

Unit 2a Someone on the phone: A cold call – teacher's notes**Time:**

Approximately 1 hour. Timings are flexible.

Aims

- to enable learners to deal with unexpected telephone cold calls

Objectives

All learners will:

- become familiar with and use some common telephone phrases
- take part in a role play, dealing with a cold call
- develop their ability to write a short dialogue

Preparation**You will need:**

- learner resources (pages 11-12): one per learner
- transcript (page 13-14): one per learner
- cut-up copies of Task 1 (page 15): one per pair
- data projector and internet connection to show the film ***A cold call***

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

Suggested procedure

To introduce the topic of cold calls, you could tell the learners an anecdote about a cold call you received at a really inconvenient time, for example just before you left home to come to college. Elicit or explain that this is a 'cold call'.

Lead-in: speaking

Dictate these questions and then write on the board so learners can check. Encourage learners to discuss the questions in pairs before you elicit group feedback.

Do you ever receive cold calls?

Who are the calls from?

What do you do when you get a cold call?

Do you like getting cold calls? Why? / Why not?

First viewing: gist questions

Tell learners they are going to watch a video, which shows some people receiving cold calls. Dictate these questions and then write on the board for learners to check.

- *Why did the man prepare the meal?*
- *Who were the telephone calls from?*
- *Why did the woman play music on her phone?*

Play the film (**A cold call**). After viewing, tell the learners to discuss the gist questions in pairs before you elicit group feedback.

Task 1: understanding the film

Hand out the learner resources (page 11 and 12). Tell learners to look at the photograph on page 11 and elicit the people's names (Arjun and Sunita) and that they are a couple. Tell learners to complete Task 1 by putting the events in order. They should work individually and then check their answers with a partner. If you think your learners would benefit, hand out the cut-up version of Task 1 (page 15) to each pair.

Differentiation: check answers of any early finishers, and get them to give feedback to other pairs.

If necessary, play the film again before you check the order as a class.

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

Task 2: useful phone phrases

Ask if the learners can remember any phrases that Sunita and Arjun said when they spoke on the phone. Accept and value all suggestions and write phrases on the board. You could encourage learners to come to the board and write up the phrases they heard themselves. Explain that the couple used lots of useful phrases when talking on the phone and tell learners to complete Task 2 by matching the phrases with the meanings. Check in pairs before you elicit group feedback.

Model the pronunciation and intonation of the phrases, and drill them chorally and with individual learners. You could write the phrases on the board, get learners to repeat them, then rub out individual words:

- *Could you hold one moment please?* could then become:
- *Could you ____ one moment please?* Then:
- *Could you ____ one _____ please?* Then:
- *_____ you ____ one _____ please?* Etc

You could also murmur the phrases, using the appropriate syllables, word stress and intonation and ask learners to tell you which phrase you are saying.

At this stage, distribute the transcript (page 13 and 14) and tell learners to find and underline the phrases and read the phrase in context.

Finally, tell learners to put their handouts face-down, and then ask them the phrases from Task 2, as follows:

Teacher: *What can you say to someone on the phone if you want them to wait?*

Learner: *Could you hold please? etc*

Your learners could also test each other in pairs.

Task 3: acting

Put learners into groups of 4 and ask them to focus on the transcript. Tell them they are going to act out the dialogue in small groups and to decide on their roles and to practise reading the dialogue aloud. Monitor, and help with pronunciation and intonation. After reading it once or twice, stronger learners could put the paper away and try to recreate the dialogue (approximately). The learners who still have their papers would then be able to prompt to keep the dialogue flowing.

Task 4: writing a dialogue

Before doing this, elicit other reasons for cold calls (e.g. selling insurance), and other ways of dealing with a call when you don't want to talk to the caller. Put the learners in pairs, and encourage them to write a dialogue. Monitor, and encourage them to incorporate phrases from the film. When they have written their dialogues they could practise acting them out with, then without the script.

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

Extension: freer speaking activities

Here are some more ideas for activities you could do after using these learner resources:

- In groups, ask the learners to discuss whether it is better to speak to cold callers, or to do what Arjun and Sunita did.
- Ask learners why they think the first caller wanted to talk with the person who pays the energy bills. (Probably to try to persuade Arjun to switch to another energy provider.) Ask if any of the learners have switched energy provider. Tell them that prices can vary a lot; ask if they know which provider has the lowest prices in their area.
- Signpost learners to the Telephone Preference Service where they can opt out of unsolicited sales or marketing calls: <http://www.tpsonline.org.uk/tps/index.html>

On the subject of household bills, you may also like to use these other *English in my home* lessons:

- **Unit 1a: Someone at the door: Electricity meter reading** (includes a video)
- **Unit 3b: Something in the post: phone bill**

You can also refer learners to the online versions of these ESOL Nexus activities on how to deal with cold calls at: <http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/someone-phone-cold-call>

Unit 2a Someone on the phone: a cold call – learner resources

A cold call



Sunita (left) and Arjun (right) are ready for a romantic meal at home.

Task 1: understanding the film

Watch the film. Put the events in order: 1-10

- a. So she asks him to wait.
- b. So he asks her not to phone again.
- c. But Sunita doesn't want to speak to him.
- d. But Arjun doesn't want to talk to the woman.
- e. The phone rings and Arjun answers it.
- f. A man wants to ask her some questions.
- g. Then she plays some music to the phone.
- h. The phone rings again and Sunita answers it.
- i. It is Sunita's birthday, so Arjun prepares a meal. **1**
- j. A woman wants to talk to him about energy bills.

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

Task 2: useful phone phrases

Read the questions. Then choose the right phrase from the film.

What do you say when...

- a. you answer the phone? *Hello? (4)*
- b. you want the caller to wait?
- c. the caller asks to speak to you?
- d. you can't speak to the caller now?
- e. you are going to answer the phone?
- f. you don't want any more calls from the caller?



5
Could you hold one moment

6
Can you delete my number please? I'm sorry, but I don't want any more calls from

Task 3: acting

Work in groups of four. Read the transcript and practise saying it aloud.

Task 4: writing a dialogue

Work with a partner. Imagine that you get a cold call. What would you say? Write a dialogue. Then practise your dialogue with your partner.

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

Cold call – video transcript

Husband OK. You can come in now!

Wife Oh thank you. And you've cooked a meal and everything!

Husband Happy birthday my darling.

Wife How romantic!

Husband I know!

(The phone rings.)

Husband Hello?

Cold caller 1 Hello Sir, how are you?

Husband Well, I'm fine thanks.

Cold caller 1 Can I speak to the person who pays the energy bills?

Husband Speaking. I pay the bills.

Cold caller 1 Well, I'm calling from a company called Cheap Energy 4 U. Would you like to
save money on your energy bills sir?

Husband Yes, of course, but,... sorry, I'm busy now. It isn't a good time to talk.

Wife OK, can I call you back in... in an hour?

Husband No, that will be worse. I'm sorry, but please don't call me again. How did you
get my number?

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

- Cold caller 1 It's on our database of numbers.
- Husband Can you delete my number please? I'm sorry, but I don't want any more calls
from you.
- Cold caller 1 I understand sir. I'll delete your number. Sorry for the problem. Good night.
- Husband Thank you. Bye bye.
- Wife Mmmm Lovely soup.
- (The phone rings.)*
- Wife I'll get it this time... Hello?
- Cold caller 2 Hello, I'm doing a customer survey. Can I ask you a few questions?
- Wife Oh, yes, could you hold one moment please?
- Cold caller 2 OK, I'll wait.
- Husband Cold calls! I really don't like cold calls.
- Wife Yeah. They're calling almost every day now. You know, somebody told me, you
can ask the phone company to stop them. If you want.
- Husband Interesting, very interesting. But not very romantic....
- Wife No, I'm sorry.
- Cold caller 2 Hello? Hello? Hello?

Unit 2a Someone on the phone: a cold call – Additional resources for teachers**Task 1: to be cut up**

So she asks him to wait.

A.

So he asks her not to phone again.

B.

But Sunita doesn't want to speak to him.

C.

But Arjun doesn't want to talk to the woman.

D.

The phone rings and Arjun answers it.

E.

A man wants to ask her some questions.

F.

Then she plays some music to the phone.

G.

The phone rings again and Sunita answers it.

H.

It is Sunita's birthday, so Arjun prepares a meal. (1)

I.

A woman wants to talk to him about energy bills.

J.

Unit 2a Someone on the phone: a cold call – answers

Someone on the phone - Teacher's pack

First viewing: gist questions

Why did the man prepare the meal?

- Because it is his wife's birthday.

Who were the calls from?

- They were cold calls. The first was from a woman who wanted to talk about energy prices. The second was from a man who wanted to ask some questions because she is doing a customer survey.

Why did the woman play music on her phone?

- Because she didn't want to talk to the caller.

Task 1: understanding the film

- 1.i
- 2.e
- 3.j
- 4.d
- 5.b
- 6.h
- 7.f
- 8.c
- 9.a
- 10.g

Task 2: useful phone phrases

- a.4
- b.5
- c.3
- d.2
- e.1
- f. 6

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

English in my home – Someone on the phone

Unit 2b – Wrong number



Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Unit 2b Someone on the phone: Wrong number – teacher's notes**Time:**

Approximately 1 hour. Timings are flexible.

Aims

- to enable learners to deal with 'wrong number' phone calls

Objectives

All learners will:

- become familiar with and use some useful phrases for dealing with wrong numbers
- take part in a role play, dealing with a wrong number

Preparation

You will need:

- learner resources (pages 22 to 25): one per learner
- a computer with internet connection and data projector to play the film ***Wrong number***

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Procedure

Lead-in: speaking task

Dictate the following questions and then write on the board for learners to check. Tell learners to discuss the questions in pairs before you elicit group feedback.

- *When was the last time someone phoned you?*
- *Who phoned you?*
- *Why did the person call you?*
- *Did they call you on your mobile or your landline?*

Write '.....number' on the board. Tell the learners they are going to learn about using English on the phone, and ask what words can go before the word *number*, for example *landline number*. Explain what this is; ask what digits landline numbers start with in the town you are in (the 'dialling code' – in London, this would be 020). Elicit suggestions for lots of collocations; be prepared to feed ideas if the learners are unsure.

Possible answers: *mobile number; work number; contact number; home number; old number; new number; wrong number*

Ensure that you deal with the last two, as these come up in the film.

First viewing of the video: gist understanding

Explain that the learners are going to watch a short film, in which a couple (Arjun and Sunita) get a phone call at home. Tell learners to watch the film and think about this question (which you could dictate).

Why did the caller telephone Arjun and Sunita?

Ask learners to discuss the question in pairs before you elicit group feedback.

Ask learners if they ever get calls like this, and if so, what they said to the caller. Elicit responses.

Task 1: understanding the film (true or false)

Distribute the learner resources (pages 22 - 25) and tell learners to read Task 1.

Ask them to discuss the questions in pairs and write the answers if they remember them. Monitor to assess whether you need to play the film again and play it again if you think it is necessary. (If you ask them if they want to see it again, more confident learners may say 'no', but shy or weaker ones may not dare ask.) Elicit group feedback of the answers.

Differentiation – for stronger learners, you could give them the additional task of writing down Sanjay's new phone number (843 655 22)

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Task 2: useful phone language

Tell the learners that Arjun and Sunita use lots of useful phrases when they are speaking on the phone. Ask them to complete Task 2. For this activity, you could check the answers of someone who finishes early and then get the rest of the group to check with that learner; i.e. he/she becomes the teacher.

Ask if the speakers are polite to each other (answer – yes); ask which sentences show the speakers being polite (suggested answers – b; d; e; i)

Task 3: who says what?

Set up Task 3 where learners decide who said which phrase in Task 2. Rather than telling them the answers, replay the film for them to identify who said what.

At this stage, you could conduct the feedback by writing the ten sentences on the board. Drill the pronunciation, intonation and sentence stress of the phrases. Rub out the phrases and tell students to turn over their handouts. Now murmur each of the phrases, using appropriate intonation and word stress and tell the students to write the phrase you are attempting to say. Students check their writing in pairs before you elicit group feedback.

Task 4: remembering the phrases

Tell learners to look at the gapped transcript on pages 24-25. Ask them to complete the text with the phrases from Task 2 / Task 3.

Differentiation – stronger learners could try to do this from memory, without looking back at the phrases in Task 2 and 3.

Task 5: role-play

In pairs, get the learners to read and role-play the wrong number phone call with the gapped transcript (starting from where the husband says 'Hello?'). Then, the stronger of the pair could place their handout face down, and the learners do the dialogue again, with prompts from the partner if necessary.

Task 6: freer speaking practise

Write some people's names on small, separate pieces of paper. You could use your learners' names.

Write a list reasons for ringing on other small, separate pieces of paper.

e.g. *I am ringing to ask if you want to come for lunch, go swimming, come to my birthday party etc.*

Put learners in pairs and give each pair 2 of the pieces of paper: a name (different to their own names) and a reason. Tell them to think of a short conversation where one learner rings a wrong number and says:

'Hi, (name on the paper), I'm ringing to ask you if you want to (reason on the paper).....'

Then they should use the phrases from Task 2 to improvise a short conversation. They could write down their conversation first if they prefer and then try acting it out.

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Extension: speaking activities

In this episode, Sanjay Patel had moved house, but (presumably) not told his friend about this. You could ask the learners if any of them have moved house. Then in small groups, get them to think of all the things people need to do when moving house, and write them in a list from the most important down to the least important. (Telling friends the new address / phone number; telling the bank, employer etc; arranging to pay the final energy and phone bills).

On the subject of dealing with people you do not know, you could use other resources from *English in my home*:

- **Unit 1b: Someone at the door: Charity collection** (includes video)

You can also refer learners to the online versions of these ESOL Nexus activities on how to deal with wrong numbers at: <http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/someone-phone-wrong-number>

Unit 2b Someone on the phone: wrong number – learner resources



Sunita (left) and Arjun (right)

Task 1: understanding the film

Watch the film. Are the statements true or false?

- Sanjay Patel lived in the flat before Sunita and Arjun.
- Arjun knows the caller.
- Arjun has a new job.
- Sunita and Arjun have grandchildren.
- The caller thinks that he is speaking to Sanjay Patel.
- The caller is Sanjay Patel's friend.
- Arjun gives the caller Sanjay Patel's new phone number.
- Sunita wants to meet the caller.

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Task 2: useful phone language

Complete the phrases from the conversation in the film. Use the words in the box.

job	family	number	help	me
speaking	worry	wrong	speaking	trouble

- It's me.
- Sorry to _____ you.
- Who do you want to _____ to?
- Are your _____ well?
- Thanks for your _____.
- Who am I _____ to?
- I think you've got the _____ number.
- How's work? How's the _____?
- Don't _____. I'm happy I could help.
- Have you got his new _____ please?

Task 3: who says what?

Who says the sentences in Task 2? Write the sentence under the person who says it.

The caller	Arjun
<i>It's me.</i>	

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Task 4: remembering the phrases

Look at the transcript of the video and fill in the gaps with phrases from Task 2 and 3.

- Husband** Do you know someone called... Sanjay Patel?
- Wife** Sanjay Patel?... No. Why?
- Husband** Look: there's a letter for him. Sanjay Patel, Flat 30, Bewick Court, Stanton Road...
- Wife** That's our address. How strange.
- Husband** Oh! I remember! He lived here before us.
- Wife** Oh yes, yes! Sanjay Patel! We've got his new address and phone number. We can write his new address here on the envelope, and send it to him.
- (The phone rings. The husband answers it.)*
- Husband** Hello?
- Caller** Hi!
- Husband** Hello.
- Caller** **(a)** _____
- Husband** Right.
- Wife** Who is it?
- Husband** I don't know.
- Caller** So, how are you?
- Husband** I'm fine, thank you, fine... And... how are you?
- Caller** Oh well, you know me. The same as always.
- Husband** Oh.. yes.
- Wife** Who is it?
- Husband** I don't know!
- Caller** So, how's work? **(b)** _____
- Husband** Well, it's good. But I only started last week. How did you know?

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

- Caller** And the family? **(c)** _____
- Husband** Yes, we're all very well thank you.
- Caller** And the grandchildren?
- Husband** The... grandchildren? My grandchildren?
- Caller** Are they all at university now?
- Husband** I'm 28? years old. My son is 6. I don't have any grandchildren. **(d)** _____
- Caller** Oh. I'm sorry. **(e)** _____
- Husband** My name's Arjun. I moved into this flat last month.
- Caller** Ah.
- Husband** **(f)** _____
- Caller** Sanjay. My friend, Sanjay Patel.
- Husband** Oh, he doesn't live here any more. He moved house last month.
- Caller** Oh dear, **(g)** _____
- Husband** Yes, I have... here it is. Have you got a pen?
- Caller** Yes.
- Husband** 843 655 22
- Caller** That's great. I'll ring that number. **(h)** _____
- Husband** No problem.
- Caller** **(i)** _____
- Husband** **(j)** _____ Bye.
- Caller** Goodbye. *(They hang up.)*
- Wife** So? Who was it?
- Husband** Oh! I don't know. I didn't ask!

Task 5: practising a phone call

Work with a partner. Practise reading the transcript aloud.

Unit 2b Someone on the phone: Wrong number – answers**First viewing: gist understanding**

The caller wanted to speak to his friend, Sanjay Patel, who lived in the flat before. He didn't want to speak to Arjun and Sunita.

Task 1: understanding the film

- a. T
- b. F
- c. T
- d. F
- e. T
- f. T
- g. T
- h. F

Task 2: useful phone language

- b. trouble
- c. speak
- d. family
- e. help
- f. speaking
- g. wrong
- h. job
- i. worry
- j. number

Task 3: who says what?

The caller a, b, d, e, f, h, j

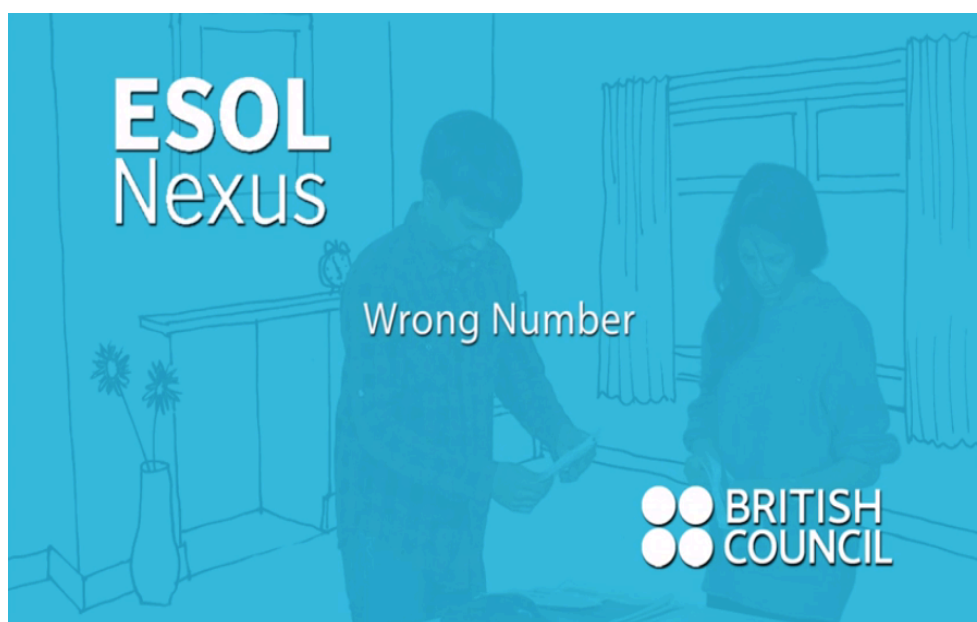
Arjun c, g, i

Task 4: remembering the phrases

- a. It's me.
- b. How's the job?
- c. Are the family well?
- d. I think you've got the wrong number.
- e. Who am I speaking to?
- f. Who do you want to speak to?
- g. Have you got his new number please?
- h. Thanks for your help.
- i. Sorry to trouble you.
- j. Don't worry. I'm happy I could help.

Someone on the phone – 'Wrong number' video

The video that accompanies the activities for Unit 2 'Someone on the phone – Wrong number' is available to watch on the ESOL Nexus website.



Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Full video transcript

Husband Do you know someone called... Sanjay Patel?
Wife Sanjay Patel?... No. Why?
Husband Look: there's a letter for him. Sanjay Patel, Flat 30, Bewick Court, Stanton Road...

Wife That's our address. How strange.
Husband Oh! I remember! He lived here before us.
Wife Oh yes, yes! Sanjay Patel! We've got his new address and phone number. We can write his new address here on the envelope, and send it to him.

(The phone rings. The husband answers it.)

Husband Hello?
Caller Hi!
Husband Hello.
Caller **It's me!**
Husband Right.
Wife Who is it?
Husband I don't know.
Caller So, how are you?
Husband I'm fine, thank you, fine... And... how are you?
Caller Oh well, you know me. The same as always.
Husband Oh.. yes.
Wife Who is it?
Husband I don't know!
Caller So, how's? **How's the job?**
Husband Well, it's good. But I only started last week. How did you know?

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

- Caller** And the family? **Are your family well?**
- Husband** Yes, we're all very well thank you.
- Caller** And the grandchildren?
- Husband** The... grandchildren? My grandchildren?
- Caller** Are they all at university now?
- Husband** I'm 28? years old. My son is 6. I don't have any grandchildren.
I think you've got the wrong number.
- Caller** Oh. I'm sorry. **Who am I speaking to?**
- Husband** My name's Arjun. I moved into this flat last month.
- Caller** Ah.
- Husband** **Who do you want to speak to?**
- Caller** Sanjay. My friend, Sanjay Patel.
- Husband** Oh, he doesn't live here any more. He moved house last month.
- Caller** Oh dear, **have you got his new number, please?**
- Husband** Yes, I have... here it is. Have you got a pen?
- Caller** Yes.
- Husband** 843 655 22
- Caller** That's great. I'll ring that number. **Thanks for your help.**
- Husband** No problem.
- Caller** **And sorry to trouble you.**
- Husband** **Don't worry. I'm happy I could help. Bye.**
- Caller** Goodbye. *(They hang up.)*
- Wife** So? Who was it?
- Husband** Oh! I don't know. I didn't ask!

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

English in my home – Someone on the phone

Unit 2c – An emergency



Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

An emergency – teacher's notes**Time:**

Approximately 60 minutes. Timings are flexible.

Aims

- to enable learners to describe household problems and request action over the phone

Objectives

Learners will be able to:

- understand the gist and detail of the film
- speak using a range of phrases to describe household problems and ask for help
- take part in a role-play dealing with an emergency

Preparation**You will need:**

- worksheets (pages 35-38): one copy per learner
- transcript (page 39): one copy per learner
- an internet connection and data projector to play the film

Suggested Procedure**Lead-in**

Hand out the **learner worksheet (page 35)** and elicit the missing word that the woman is saying (*emergency*). You could play hangman if learners cannot guess the word. Elicit that the lesson is about emergencies, and more specifically, emergencies in the home.

Elicit other typical household emergencies, e.g. the boiler breaks, somebody loses their keys, the heating doesn't work, there's an electricity cut. Put the learners into pairs, and ask them to find out whether their partners have had any problems like this, and if so what they did and who they contacted.

During feedback, discuss who they need to call if there is a problem, and establish that for many people, the first point of call would be their Housing Association.

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Task 1: understanding vocabulary

Tell the learners that they are going to watch a video about an emergency in a home, and that you are going to start by showing them some vocabulary which they need to understand.

Hand out **worksheets (page 36-38)** and display Task 1 on the projector if possible.

Ask learners to do Task 1 and compare their answers in pairs. Make sure all learners understand *leak* and *plumber* – you might need to concept-check these items. Elicit possible causes of leaks (bath, shower, radiator, washing machine, dishwasher), and reasons why they are a problem (wet floors are dangerous; water might go down into another flat; you can't use the device that has a leak etc).

Check pronunciation and word stress.

Task 2: using vocabulary

Ask learners to complete Task 2 and encourage them to check their answers in pairs by reading their answers aloud. Elicit feedback and check pronunciation and intonation.

First viewing of the video

Tell the learners that they are now going to watch the film in which a young couple, Sunita and Arjun, have an emergency in their home. Explain that the film contains all the words from Task 1. In pairs, tell learners to use all these words to predict what they think will happen in the film. Play the film and ask them to discuss whether their predictions were right. Elicit whole group feedback where you and the learners compare their predictions with what really happened.

Task 3: understanding the film

Tell learners to read the questions in Task 3. If necessary, read the questions aloud and check understanding.

Play the film again, and then ask learners to discuss the questions in pairs, using the phrases from Task 1 and Task 2. Elicit feedback, and encourage learners to give full answers.

Task 4: describing a problem

Explain that Sunita and Arjun use some useful language to describe the problem to Mr Konik. Encourage learners to work on their own first to put the words in order before checking their answers with their partner. When you elicit feedback, write the sentences on the board, concept-check and drill with a focus on pronunciation and intonation. Then focus on one sentence at a time and erase all the words one by one. When you erase each word, replace it with a line and ask them to say the phrase aloud e.g. *It's urgent* > *It's _* > *It _ _* > *_ _ _*. Tell learners to practise saying the sentences to each other just by looking at the gapped sentences on the board.

Remember that the sentences are quite challenging for learners but really useful, so they need (and will enjoy) plenty of practice.

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Task 5: describing a problem

Task 5 is an opportunity to notice the use of the salient language in Task 4. Play the film again for the learners to note down the order in which they hear the phrases from Task 4. (You could conduct the feedback for Tasks 4 and 5 together with stronger groups or if you are pushed for time.)

Differentiation – As the ordering task is quite challenging, you may set a similar but simpler task to some of your learners, by asking *Which of the phrases in Task 4 do both Arjun and Sunita say?* (Answer – a and c)

Task 6: role-play

Put the learners into groups of 3. Give each learner a copy of the **transcript** (page 39), ask them to decide who will play which role and then to practise reading the dialogue aloud. Monitor, and help with pronunciation and intonation.

In groups, then ask the learners to write and act out a situation involving a phone call to the Housing Association (or landlord) about another household emergency (e.g. broken boiler, leaking roof, kitchen fire etc). Encourage them to adapt some of the phrases from Task 4, such as:

Something's wrong with the (boiler / heating...)

We've got a big problem in the ... (bathroom / garden...)

There's ... all over the ... (smoke all over the kitchen...)

Could you send someone to... (look at it / mend it) please?

Extension

Ask the learners if they have any problems in their flat (e.g. something that doesn't work, or something that leaks). Establish who they need to contact, then help them prepare for a phone call to this person to get the problem sorted out. Role-play the phone conversation with the learners.

Refer students to the online versions of these ESOL Nexus activities about *An emergency*:
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/someone-phone-emergency>

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Learner worksheet

- Look at the picture below.
- The lady is making a telephone call to ask for help about a problem in her house.
- What is the missing word?



Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Task 1: understanding vocabulary

Match the words to the pictures.

washing machine

phone

mop

bucket

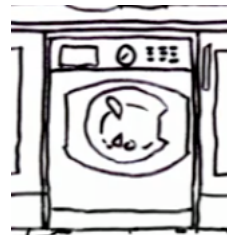
leak

plumber

boots



phone



Task 2: using vocabulary

Complete the sentences with a word from the box in Task 1.

I put all the dirty clothes in the (1).....

Can I use the (2).....? I need to make a call.

I wash my kitchen floor with a (3)..... of water and a (4).....

I'm going out, but it's raining, so I'm going to wear my (5).....

When I have a problem with my toilet I call a (6)..... He's very good.

There's a (7)..... in my roof, and water's going all over my bedroom floor.

Task 3: understanding the film

1. Why does Sunita say 'Oh no!'?
2. What does Arjun give her? Why?
3. Who phones Sunita and Arjun? Why?
4. Why does Sunita say 'That's not fine'?
5. Why does Arjun say 'My wife's wearing boots in the kitchen?'?
6. What does 'ASAP' mean?

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack



Sunita with a bucket and mop (left). Arjun (right)

Task 4: describing a problem

Put the words in order.

a.	urgent It 's	<i>It's urgent</i>
b.	It broken. 's	
c.	There's the floor. water all over	
d.	got We've in kitchen. a problem the big	
e.	's It leaking	
f.	someone We need now.	
g.	's It emergency. an	
h.	Next no good. week is	
i.	wrong with the Something 's washing machine.	
j.	send Could you someone to please? fix it	

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Task 5: describing a problem

Watch the film again. What order do you hear sentences a-j?

- | | | | |
|------|----|----|----|
| 1. i | 3. | 5. | 7. |
| 2. | 4. | 6. | 8. |

Task 6: role-play

Work in pairs and practise role-play phone calls to talk about other household problems.

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Transcript

Wife Oh no! Arjun! Something's wrong with the washing machine. It's leaking!

Husband Oh! Well, the floor was dirty. The water will clean it.

Wife There's water all over the floor.

Husband *(He gives her a pair of boots.)* These will keep your feet dry.

Wife Ugh! I'm phoning the housing association.

Mr Konik Thank you for calling Giston Housing Association. Please leave a message.

Wife Hello, this is Sunita Chowdry. I live in Bewick Court, in flat 30. We've got a bi problem in the kitchen. Please could you phone me back? It's urgent, so please call me back soon. My number is 020 7442 3204. Thank you. Bye.

(The phone rings. The wife is mopping the floor.)

Husband I have to do everything in this house! Hello?

Mr Konik Hello, am I speaking with Mr Chowdry please?

Husband Speaking.

Mr Konik Hello. This is Mr Konik from Giston Housing Association.

Husband Ah, thank you for calling back.

Mr Konik Your wife left a message about a problem in the kitchen. What's wrong?

Husband It's the washing machine. It's broken.

Mr Konik I see.

Husband Could you send someone to fix it please?

Mr Konik OK. I'll contact a plumber. But it'll probably be next week.

Husband That's fine. Next week.

Wife No, that's *not* fine! We need someone now!

Husband Actually, next week is no good. It's urgent. There's water all over the floor. My wife's wearing boots in the kitchen.

Mr Konik I see.

Husband It's an emergency.

Mr Konik Right, I see. Well, I'll try and get you a plumber ASAP.

Husband I'm sorry?

Mr Konik As soon as possible. I'll contact the plumber now. I'll tell him that it's an emergency. And I'll ask him to contact you.

Husband That's great. I'll wait for his call... ASAP.

Mr Konik Thanks then. Bye.

Husband Bye..... *(He hangs up.)* You see? The boots were a good idea!

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Answers**Task 2: using vocabulary**

1. washing machine
2. phone
3. bucket
4. mop
5. boots
6. plumber
7. leak

Task 3: understanding the film

1. Because the washing machine is leaking
2. He gives her boots because the floor is wet.
3. Mr Konik (from Giston Housing Association). He phones about the leaking washing machine.
4. She wants the plumber now, not next week.
5. He wants to persuade Mr Konik to send the plumber now, not next week.
6. As soon as possible

Task 4: describing a problem

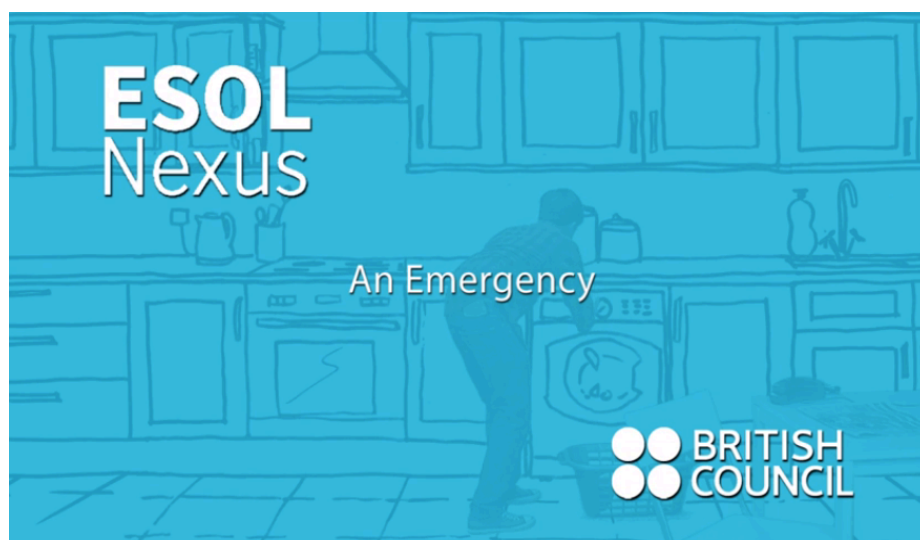
- a. It's urgent
- b. It's broken.
- c. There's water all over the floor.
- d. We've got a big problem in the kitchen.
- e. It's leaking.
- f. We need someone now.
- g. It's an emergency.
- h. Next week is no good.
- i. Something's wrong with the washing machine.
- j. Could you send someone to fix it please?

Task 5: describing a problem

1. i
2. e
3. c
4. d
5. a
6. b
7. j
8. f
9. h (then a and c again)
10. g

Someone on the phone – ‘An emergency’ video

The video that accompanies the activities for Unit 2 ‘Someone on the phone – An emergency’ is available to watch on the ESOL Nexus website.



Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

English in my home – Someone on the phone

Unit 2d – Getting a plumber



Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Getting a plumber: Teacher's notes

Time:

Approximately 60 minutes. Timings are flexible.

Aims

- to enable learners to ask for clarification and make arrangements over the phone

Objectives

All learners will be able to:

- understand the main ideas and detail of the film
- use common phone phrases to make arrangements
- take part in a role-play to make arrangements

Preparation

You will need:

- learner resources (pages 46-49) – one copy per learner
- an internet connection and data projector to show the film **Getting a plumber**

The scenario in this film follows film 2c (An emergency), so you may like to use 2c before using 2d, but this is not essential.

Suggested procedure

Elicit the different tradespeople who sometimes come to a home to mend / install or make something e.g. gas engineer, electrician, plumber, meter reader or builder etc. Write suggestions on the whiteboard in a list. Teach and concept-check these items, and drill the pronunciation to the group and to individual learners. Add the following question around the list:

a plumber

an electrician

Has *a meter reader* ever come to your home? Yes, he/she has. No he/she hasn't.

a builder

a gas engineer

What did he/she do?

Did you speak to him/her on the phone? Was it easy or difficult? Why?

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Ask the learners to discuss these questions in pairs. Give them a couple of minutes to do this, and then while conducting feedback, focus on any communication difficulties the learners have experienced while talking to tradespeople on the phone or face to face.

Explain that they will watch a film in which a non-native speaker of English speaks to a plumber on the phone. She doesn't always understand him, and has to ask him to repeat or explain things. It is important to be able to do this in English! The activities will help the learners to learn some useful phrases to do this, and to make appointments.

Distribute the **learner resources (pages 46 and 48)** and show them the pictures of the three people. Especially if the learners haven't just seen film 2c, explain the roles of the three characters; explain that Mr Konik works at Giston Housing Association. Ask the learners what they think is happening in the pictures.

Task 1: understanding the film

Give the learners a minute to read the Task 1 questions before playing the film. After viewing, tell learners to discuss their answers in pairs. Monitor to assess how much they have understood, then discuss the answers as a class.

Task 2: vocabulary

Ask if the learners can remember the phrases that Gary explained to Sunita, and that Sunita was practising at the end of the film. Tell the learners that Task 2 helps them to learn these phrases. Allow them a couple of minutes to do the task, then conduct feedback. Concept-check the phrases to check that they have understood the meaning, and drill the pronunciation.

Task 3: phone language

Explain that the film has lots of phrases that plumbers, electricians and other tradespeople often use on the phone, as well as some phrases that the learners can use when they speak to tradespeople. Task 3 is about these phrases. Ask them to do Task 3 then compare their answers in pairs or groups. Then play the film for them to check. Explain that the sentences 1-10 in Task 3 are in the same order as they occur in the film. (If you want to save time, you could play the film only up until 1:56, when the phone call ends.

Differentiation – for weaker learners, or for those who simply need more time, you could tell learners to just study Sunita's sentences.

Task 4: the phone language in the transcript

Task 4 checks that the learners have learnt the phrases from Task 3. Hand out the **gapped transcript (page 49)** and give learners two minutes to read through the dialogue. Ask them if they want to see the film again before doing Task 4. If they wish to, ask them to listen and try to remember the phrases, but not to write anything during the film. Allow the learners to do this in small groups, then elicit whole-class feedback.

Put the learners in pairs, and ask them to practise reading the transcript; use just the plumber's phone call to Sunita for this (from: *Hello Mrs Chowdry* to *Bye.*)

Someone on the phone – Teacher's pack

Task 5: phoning a tradesperson

At this point in the class, pause to review learning so far. Ask the learners to tell you from memory (without looking at the transcripts) some phrases from the dialogue that they could use when speaking with a plumber to arrange a visit (e.g. *Can you come now?*), phrases to use when you don't understand someone (*I didn't understand; sorry? You speak very fast; What do you mean?*) Ask if they remember any useful vocabulary that the plumber used (*tied up; half twelve; doing another job; at yours; cheers*)

Put the learners in pairs. Ask them to think of a tradesperson, then write a phone conversation between themselves and the electrician / builder / gas engineer to arrange the visit. Encourage them to include some of the language from the film. As you monitor, you may need to help by suggesting something that the tradesperson might say and which the ESOL learner might not understand, in order to include some of the phrases for dealing with misunderstandings.

Encourage learners to act out their dialogues with their partner or in front of the class. If your learners enjoy healthy competition, tell them to vote on a winning performance.

Extension

After this, you could return to the closing sequence (perhaps play it again), in which Sunita speaks to herself in the mirror and practises using the phrases she has learnt.

Put the learners in groups of 4-6, and ask them to discuss these questions:

Sunita speaks to herself in the mirror. Is this a good way to practise new vocabulary?

How else can you practise using new words?

Refer students to the online versions of these ESOL Nexus activities on *Getting a plumber* at:
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/someone-phone-getting-plumber>

Getting a plumber: Learner resources



Mr Konik

(Giston Housing Association)

Gary

(the plumber)

Sunita

Task 1: understanding the film

Watch the film, and answer the questions.

- Why does the plumber phone Sunita?
- What is Sunita's problem?
- What time is he going to come?
- Why can't he come earlier?
- What is Sunita doing at the end of the film?

Task 2: vocabulary

*Match the phrases **in bold** 1-4 with the meanings a-d.*

- | | |
|--|------------------------|
| 1. What's up? | a. busy |
| 2. I'm tied up this morning | b. 12.30 |
| 3. I'll finish at about half twelve | c. at your home |
| 4. I could be at yours between half twelve and one. | d. What's the problem? |

Someone on the phone – Teacher's Pack

Task 3: phone language

What do the speakers say? Circle the correct underlined word.

1 Are / Could you call Mr and Mrs Chowdry ASAP?



2 It's the plumber there / here: Gary.

4 So, what's / where's

3 Oh yes, thanks for call / calling.

5 It's / This is the washina machine. leaking.

6 Can / Do you come now?

8 What do you say /

7 Not now I'm frightened / afraid... I'm tied up all

9 I can come and watch / see your washing machine

10 I'm sorry, I didn't understood / understand. You speak very fast.



Someone on the phone – Teacher's Pack

Task 4: the phone language in the transcript

Now look at the transcript. Fill in the gaps with the correct words. Then read the transcript aloud with a partner.

Task 5: phoning a tradesperson

Work with a partner. Imagine a phone call to another tradesperson. Write the dialogue. Then act out your dialogue for the class.

Transcript – fill in the gaps

Write one word in each gap. Use words from the video.

- Mr Konik** OK. So, they've got water everywhere in the kitchen. Could you 1 call Mr and Mrs Chowdry 2 _____?
- Plumber** OK, yeah, I'll do that now. Cheers.
- Mr Konik** OK. Thanks. Bye. *(He hangs up, and the plumber dials another number.)*
- Plumber** Hello, Mrs Chowdry?
- Wife** Hello?
- Plumber** 3 _____ the plumber here, Gary. I just got your number from Mr Konik, at the Housing Association.
- Wife** Oh yes, thanks 4 _____ calling.
- Plumber** So, what's 5 _____?
- Wife** I'm sorry?
- Plumber** What's the problem? What's wrong?
- Wife** Oh, yes. 6 _____ the washing machine. It's 7 _____.
- Plumber** OK, well, I'm sure I can help.
- Wife** Oh great. 8 _____ you come now?
- Plumber** Not now I'm 9 _____. I'm doing another job at the moment. I'm 10 _____ up all morning.
- Wife** 'Tied up'? What do you 11 _____?
- Plumber** Sorry, it's the way I speak. I speak very fast! I'm tied up, I'm busy. I'm doing another job. But I'll finish at about 12 _____ twelve.
- Wife** What time, sorry?
- Plumber** Half twelve. Half past twelve.
- Wife** Oh yes.
- Plumber** I can come 13 _____ see your washing machine then. I've got your address here off Mr Konik. It's not far. So I could be 14 _____ yours, between half twelve and one.
- Wife** I'm sorry, I didn't 15 _____. You speak very fast. I didn't understand. At my..? When?
- Plumber** At your place... at your house, at your flat.
- Wife** Yes. Thank you.
- Plumber** OK then. Cheers. Bye.
- Wife** Bye. *(They both hang up.)*
- I can't come now, I'm all tied up. I'm tied up, very busy. Very busy. I can't come now, I'm very busy. I'll be there at half twelve... half twelve. I'll be at your place at half twelve.

Full video transcript - Getting a plumber

- M Konik** OK. So, they've got water everywhere in the kitchen. Could you call Mr and Mrs Chowdry ASAP?

Someone on the phone – Teacher's Pack

Plumber	OK, yeah, I'll do that now. Cheers.
Mr Konik	OK. Thanks. Bye. <i>(He hangs up, and dials another number.)</i> Hello, Mrs Chowdry?
Wife	Hello?
Plumber	It's the plumber here, Gary. I just got your number from Mr Konik, at the Housing Association.
Wife	Oh yes, thanks for calling.
Plumber	So, what's up?
Wife	I'm sorry?
Plumber	What's the problem? What's wrong?
Wife	Oh, yes. It's the washing machine. It's leaking.
Plumber	OK, well, I'm sure I can help.
Wife	Oh great. Can you come now?
Plumber	Not now I'm afraid. I'm doing another job at the moment. I'm tied up all morning.
Wife	'Tied up'? What do you mean?
Plumber	Sorry, it's the way I speak. I speak very fast! I'm tied up, I'm busy. I'm doing another job. But I'll finish at about half twelve.
Wife	What time, sorry?
Plumber	Half twelve. Half past twelve.
Wife	Oh yes.
Plumber	I can come and see your washing machine then. I've got your address here off Mr Konik. It's not far. So I could be at yours, between half twelve and one.
Wife	I'm sorry, I didn't understand. You speak very fast. I didn't understand. At my? When?
Plumber	At your place... at your house, at your flat.
Wife	Yes. Thank you.
Plumber	OK then. Cheers. Bye.
Wife	Bye. <i>(They both hang up.)</i> I can't come now, I'm all tied up. I'm tied up, very busy. Very busy. I can't come now, I'm very busy. I'll be there at half twelve... half twelve. I'll be at your place at half twelve.

Unit 2d Someone on the phone: Getting a plumber – answers

Task 1: understanding the film

- Because Mr Konik asks the plumber to phone Sunita and make an appointment
- Her washing machine is leaking, and there's water in the kitchen.
- 12.30-1.00
- He is busy doing another job.
- She is practising using the vocabulary that the plumber explained to her.

Someone on the phone – Teacher's Pack

Task 2: vocabulary

1. d
2. a
3. b
4. c

Task 3: phone language

1. Could
2. here
3. calling
4. what's
5. It's
6. Can
7. afraid
8. mean
9. see
10. understand

Task 4: the phone language in the transcript

1. call
2. ASAP
3. It's
4. for
5. up
6. It's
7. leaking
8. Can
9. afraid
10. tied
11. mean
12. half
13. and
14. at
15. understand

Someone on the phone – 'Getting a plumber' video

The video that accompanies the activities for Unit 2 'Someone on the phone – Getting a plumber' is available to watch on the ESOL Nexus website.

